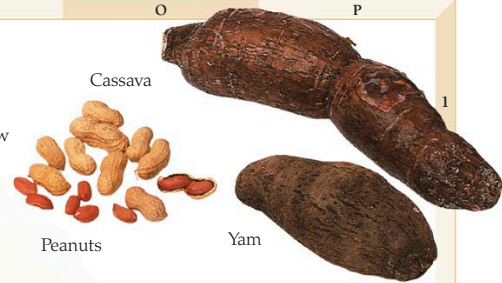




FOOD CROPS

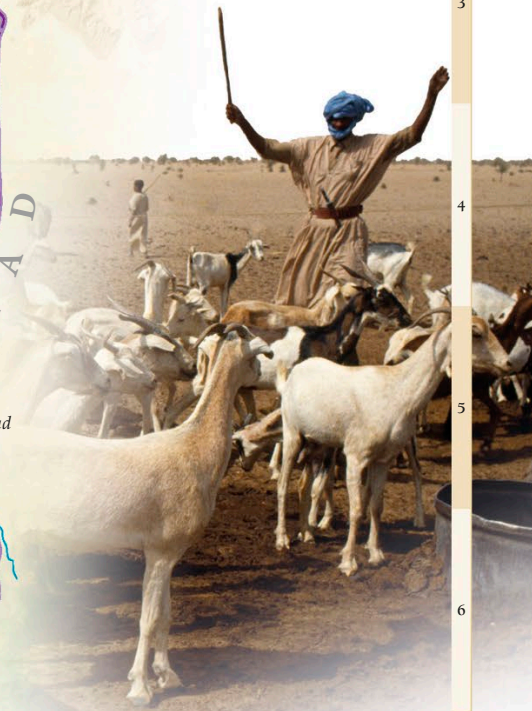
In wetter, southern regions, root vegetables such as yams and cassava are grown for food. Peanuts, which also grow underground, are cultivated in the north for export or to cook in traditional stew.



Peanuts

Yam

Lake Volta in Ghana, formed by a dam, is the largest artificial lake in the world.



WEST AFRICAN FARMERS

In the dry northern areas, crop farming is restricted to when and where seasonal rain falls. Herders are partly nomadic and they need to follow the rains in search of grazing land for their animals. Further south, where rainfall is higher, farmers grow a wider variety of crops for their families to eat, and for sale.

Herbs, shells, bones, and sticks used by traditional healers



MEDICINE AND HEALING

Many people here seek advice from a traditional healer if they are ill. Often the healer is also a religious leader. Treatment may include the use of herbs or magical items to fight off the enemy spirit. Healers may also chant and dance to attract the good spirits.

MASKED DANCERS

Masks, such as this one from the Dan tribe of the Ivory Coast, are worn by dancers who take on different characters during tribal ceremonies. Round-eyed masks represent males, while straight-eyed masks are for females. However, the actual dancers are always men.

